

MORPHOLOGY & SPELLING

High School Foundations | Unit 3

Prefix super-



Today I am learning that the prefix super- often means above, beyond or over.

1 Learn the Meaning

The prefix super- often carries the idea above, beyond or over. In academic and technical words, it can describe position, degree or something extending beyond an ordinary level.

superstructure
structure built above

superimpose
place one thing over another

superhuman
beyond ordinary human ability

superheated
heated beyond a usual point

2 Build the Word

Add super- to the base or related word. Build the new word, then write a short meaning clue.

Base / related	Add	New word	Meaning clue
human	super-		
structure	super-		
impose	super-		
heat	super-		
natural	super-		

3 Read and Notice

Read the passage below.

In a design and engineering project, students investigated structures that extend above or beyond an ordinary level. They began with a bridge diagram and identified the superstructure, the part built above its supporting base. Next, they used mapping software to superimpose an older plan over a modern image so they could compare how the site had changed.

The science group then explored materials exposed to extreme conditions. They discussed superheated steam and why it behaves differently from steam at a lower temperature. In a separate discussion, the class examined words such as superhuman and supernatural, noticing that super- can suggest something beyond an ordinary human or natural limit. Across each example, the prefix gave a useful clue about position or degree.



Highlight the super- words. Underline the base or related word, then decide whether super- means above/over or beyond.

4 Word Detective

Choose one super- word from the passage and investigate its structure and meaning.

- Write a super- word from the passage.

- What base or related word can you identify?

- Does super- suggest above/over or beyond?

- Explain the whole word in your own words.

5 Sort the Words

Sort the words by the meaning clue carried by super-.

superstructure superimpose superscript superheated

superhuman supernatural superpower superfast

Above / over

Beyond / greater degree

6 Use It in Writing



Complete the sentence starters.

- The prefix super- helps me understand that _____

- Use one super- word in a sentence that makes its meaning clear.



Parent check

Tick the skills your learner has demonstrated.

- ☐ Recognises super- as meaning above / beyond / over
- ☐ Identifies a base or related word
- ☐ Explains how the prefix changes the whole-word meaning
- ☐ Reads and uses target words in context



Capture idea:

Find a super- word in a science, technology or information text. Record the word, identify the base, and explain the meaning clue.